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Arlington County Board Names Robert Cox as New Chairman (Evening Star, 3 January 1952, p. A-21)

[Evening Star, Washington, D.C., Thursday, 3 January 1952, p. A-21. Only the article headed "Arlington County Board Names Robert Cox as New Chairman" is reproduced, as the Library of Congress's text layer gives it, with plain OCR slips corrected (for example "emplqftaaent" for "employment"); the rest of the page is not reproduced.]

Arlington County Board Names Robert Cox as New Chairman

Arlington non-partisans, with a 5-2 majority on the County Board, have elected one of their members, Robert W. Cox, as chairman for 1952. Mr. Cox, 36, is assistant executive officer of the Federal Communications Commission.

As soon as he was chosen last night, Mr. Cox, who had said he was not campaigning for the job, pulled a six page prepared statement from his pocket and read some of his plans for the year ahead.

Prior to his election, Robert A. Peck, Republican, made an unsuccessful effort to nominate the other political party member, Alfred E. Frisbie, Democrat, for chairman. Mr. Peck said Mr. Frisbie, whose term expires at the end of this year, is the only holdover member who has not served as chairman and that his services to the board during the last three years should be recognized.

The nomination of Mr. Cox was made by the newly elected member, Alan L. Dean, and was seconded by Daniel A. Dugan, the other two non-partisans. Mr. Dean said it was fitting for Mr. Cox to be named head of the local governing body inasmuch as his views are closely identified with the board majority. In the vote, Mr. Frisbie joined Mr. Dean and Mr. Dugan, while Mr. Peck and Mr. Cox abstained.

Mr. Cox said in his statement that the board will intensify its efforts in 1952 to learn what the people want and will increase citizen participation in developing county programs. "In the coming year," Mr. Cox said, "we hope to demonstrate by deed and by logic to an ever-increasing number of citizens the proposition that non-partisan, local elections are an

important element in good local government. When a sufficient number of citizens come to understand this basic truth and to say so publicly, perhaps our representatives in the General Assembly will be willing to let us vote on the question."

Mr. Peck said he did not want this to indicate that all members of the board do not believe in the two-party system on the local level. Mr. Dean said the general trend is to govern locally on the basis of merit and the "two-party arena should not be in any urban community."

Although the manager-board form of government in Arlington is "the best yet developed," it has serious flaws, Mr. Cox said. Two bills he hopes will be introduced this year in the General Assembly would permit employment of the county manager for an indefinite term and appointment of department heads by the manager.

The board will continue its efforts to assure protection of consumers against improper and unreasonable utility rates and to see that the best services are obtained, Mr. Cox said. Some people, he added, do not consider these "proper areas of activity for our governing body." A study of housing is under way and if the facts indicate need for rent control, the board will request establishment of rent controls, he said. He also said the board will continue to oppose present milk regulations.

County Manager A. T. Lundberg told the board the county has the personnel to carry out the fundamentals of the program outlined by the new chairman. The board reappointed Mrs. Ruby G. Simpson as clerk at her present salary of \$4,400.